



skins by performing a certain set of actions with that gun while in a match. This made people grind the game for countless hours for that simple in-game item.

What the system has become in today's date

In-game rewards have come a long way from where they started and have now evolved into something that all games provide.

However, just because all games provide a particular thing does NOT mean that it will always be good. Sure, some games still know how to do things right. Call of Duty's golden and diamond skins, which you get for a gun when you grind enough with it, still gives players some incentive to play the game. This is a classic example of in-game rewards. Even though CoD has also been focusing heavily on their pay to unlock content and in-game skins, they have still given the olden days the same importance as they did earlier.

On the other hand however, you have games such as Apex Legends where you can't get anything if not for the Apex Packs whose rewards depend on nothing but luck. You could spend thousands and thousands of your hard earned money only to get one or two good skins that you really wanted.

So, that brings us back to the question, are in game rewards worth it anymore? Well, the answer isn't as simple as you might expect. Such a thing would depend on a per-game basis. Quite a few studios churn out free in-game rewards, simply giving stuff away to people who log into their game every day for a certain amount of time. However, there still are developers out there who know

where to draw the line and have a balanced amount of rewards which constitute of stuff people would actually want to show off.



Gold Camo in the Call of Duty Games

Another great example of this would be Riot Games' Valorant in which every agent has a contract.

Once you complete an agent's contract, you get a gun skin themed to the agent whose contract you just completed. Apart from the gun skin, you also get sprays, cards, and gun buddies throughout the contract which makes it seem worth it to be spending time in the game. Still, the saturation of players unlocking each and every contract is so high that even if you complete all of them, it'll barely make you feel special.

Why has this happened?

Most of these pointless prizes can be credited to devs wanting player retention so bad that they were ready to go to any limit in order to get players to play their game. Just the act of logging-in shows that a person is still interested in the game and would be ready to play if the time was right.

And sure enough, once you open a game for that login reward, you can't help yourself but play a couple of matches just to freshen up a bit



Yoru Agent Contract skin from Valorant

and have some fun. Either way, the devs get what they want and the players played the game even if it was for a single, probably useless, reward that they got.

In-game rewards have solely become a tool for game devs to keep and increase their player base. The other aspect of in-game rewards has been lost. An actual reward system that was brought into place to validate the players who decided to stick with the game. Now, in-game rewards have become just the opposite. Players used to get rewarded for playing and it made sense; you spend the time, and you get a goodie. What we see now is a huge influx of rewards that you get even before you start playing the game, putting



Apex Legends Mobile Login Rewards

you under the illusion that your time will be valued and rewarded handsomely which does initially happen, but stops after some time when you have given enough time to the game that you simply log in for your own pleasure and not the rewards.

Conclusion

Even though we mostly discussed the negative side of things, there still are games such as Elden Ring that came out recently and had no such thingamajigs as in-game rewards. People played the game for what it was and didn't need to be incentivised to play it. The devs believed in their game and knew people were going to buy it.

Games like these still make us believe that there is hope for things to get better. Getting better things in game and NOT for free. Put in some effort for those skins people and you will get better stuff! Remember that. *